FY-901

Reg. No. : .....

Name : .....

FIRST YEAR HIGHER SECONDARY
IMPROVEMENT/SUPPLEMENTARY EXAMINATION, OCTOBER 2026

Part – I

ENGLISH

Time : 2½ Hours

Cool-off time : 15 Minutes

Maximum : 80 Scores

General Instructions to Candidates :

- There is a 'Cool-off time' of 15 minutes in addition to the writing time.
- Use the 'Cool-off time' to get familiar with questions and to plan your answers.
- Read questions carefully before answering.
- Write answers to the specific number of questions as instructed.

Questions 1 – 8 : Answer all the questions. **(8 × 1 = 8)**

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow :

His first year at Cambridge was worse than that at Oxford. His slipshod mathematical background caught up with him, and he found general relativity extremely tough. Another far more disastrous problem arose then. ... He'd fallen once or twice for no apparent reason. The following autumn, at Cambridge, he had trouble tying his shoes and sometimes, he had difficulty talking.

1. The 'he' referred to is _____. (1)
Stephen Hawking

2. What made general relativity extremely tough for 'him' ? (1)
His slipshod mathematical background.

3. 'Another far more disastrous problem arose then.' What is the 'problem' referred to ? (1)
He had fallen once or twice for no apparent reason.

4. Pick out the word from the passage that means 'clear'. (1)
Apparent.

ANSWER (1-4)

1) Stephen Hawking.
2) His slipshod mathematical background.
3)He had fallen once or twice for no apparent reason.
4)Apparent.

Read the following lines and answer the questions that follow :

The glories of our blood and state
Are shadows, not substantial things;
There is no armour against Fate;
Death lays his icy hand on kings:
Sceptre and Crown
Must tumble down,
And in the dust be equal made
With the poor crooked scythe and spade.

5. What, according to the poet, are 'shadows' ? (1)

6. 'Death lays his icy hand on kings...' The poetic device used in this line is _____. (1)

7. Pick out an example of metonymy from the lines. (1)

8. The word that means 'a protective shield' is _____. (1)

ANSWER (5-8)

5) Shadows are the glories of our blood and state.
6) Personification.
7) Sceptre and Crown.
8) Armour.

Questions 9 – 12 : Answer any three of the following. Each question carries 2 scores. **(3 × 2 = 6)**

9. You are a tour guide at Kadavu, addressing a group of tourists who have assembled to watch the turtle calling. Write two **instructions** that you wish to give them.

- Please remain silent while watching the turtles.
- Do not disturb the turtles or their natural habitat.

10. **Report** the following conversation between Maggie and Mrs. Clifford, her mother :

Mrs. Clifford : Will Mr. Gupta visit me ?

Maggie : I've informed him that you wish to see him.

- Mrs. Clifford asked Maggie whether Mr. Gupta would visit her.
- Maggie replied that she had informed him that Mrs. Clifford wished to see him.

11. Dr. Kalam asks the youth to fight the hardest battle, that is, finding 'a UNIQUE YOU'. Based on your reading of Kalam's speech titled 'I will Fly', write two pieces of **advice** for the youth, to find their uniqueness.

- Discover your talents and develop your unique abilities.
- Believe in yourself and work hard to achieve your goals.

12. **Complete the following sentences suitably :**

(a) If we start climbing the hill by 4:30 in the morning _____ (watch the sunrise from the hilltop by 6:00 am).

(b) _____ (start early in the evening) we would have arrived at the Belgian Frontiers by midnight.

(a) If we start climbing the hill by 4:30 in the morning, we can watch the sunrise from the hilltop by 6:00 am.

(b) If we had started early in the evening, we would have arrived at the Belgian Frontiers by midnight.

Questions 13 – 19 : Answer any five of the following. Each question carries 4 scores. **(5 × 4 = 20)**

13. **Edit the following sentences :**

I always tells my friends that we should sleeping at last for seven hours. Sound sleep make us healthy and happy.

I always tell my friends that we should sleep for at least seven hours. Sound sleep makes us healthy and happy.

14. **Fill up the blanks choosing the correct cohesive device from the brackets.**

(thus, though, while, in order to)

The young seagull was not able to fly. ___(a)___ his parents had encouraged him to fly, he failed in his attempt. Then his mother decided to help him. ___(b)___ make him fly, she picked up a piece of fish and took it to him. He fell off his ledge ___(c)___ attempting to get near his mother. Then his wings spread and ___(d)___ he made his first flight.

- (a) Though
- (b) In order to
- (c) While
- (d) Thus

15. **Justify the title 'The Price of Flowers'.**

The title 'The Price of Flowers' is appropriate because the story shows the deep love and sacrifice of a poor girl named Maggie. She sells flowers to earn money and wishes to visit her brother's grave. The story highlights the emotional value of love and sacrifice, which is far greater than the price of flowers.

16. You are doing rescue work in a locality hit by landslide. Write four **instructions** that you wish to give the rest of your team members on the first day of the operation.

- Wear safety equipment at all times.
- Follow the instructions of the rescue team leader.
- Do not enter damaged buildings without permission.
- Help the injured and move them to safe places.

17. **Elaborate on the idea** behind the following lines :

If you can dream – and not make dreams your master;
If you can think – and not make thoughts your aim,
If you can meet with Triumph and Disaster
And treat those two impostors just the same:
If you can bear to hear the truth you've spoken
Twisted by knaves to make a trap for fools,
Or watch the things you gave your life to, broken,
And stoop and build 'em up with worn-out tools;

The lines convey the importance of self-control, patience and courage in life. We should have dreams but must not become controlled by them. We should think wisely and act with purpose. We must treat success and failure equally and remain calm in both situations. We should also have the courage to face criticism and rebuild our lives even after great losses.

18. You are one of the spectators who gathered at the gas works of La Villette to watch the take off of Le Horla. You are narrating the incident to one of your friends. Prepare your **narration**.

Yesterday, I witnessed an amazing incident at the gas works of La Villette. A huge balloon called Le Horla was ready for take-off. A large crowd had gathered to watch the event. As the gas filled the balloon, it slowly rose into the sky. The spectators cheered with excitement as it moved higher and higher. It was a wonderful sight that I will never forget.

19. A debate is conducted in your class on the topic 'We cannot live without technology'. Write **four arguments** against it.

- Excessive use of technology can affect our physical and mental health.
- Technology can reduce face-to-face communication.
- Overdependence on technology can weaken our thinking and problem-solving skills.
- Technical failures can disrupt our daily activities.

Questions 20 – 25 : Answer any five of the following. Each question carries 6 scores. **(5 × 6 = 30)**

20. Parental guidance is an important factor in the moulding of an individual. Analyse this statement in the light of your reading of 'His First Flight' and write your view in a **paragraph**.

Parental guidance plays an important role in shaping an individual. In the story 'His First Flight', the young seagull is afraid to fly, even though his siblings have already learned to do so. His parents encourage him, but he refuses to take the risk. Finally, his mother tempts him with a piece of fish and makes him dive towards it. This forces him to spread his wings and fly. Once he succeeds, he gains confidence and learns to trust his abilities. The story shows that parents should encourage their children to overcome their fears and become independent. Proper guidance, motivation and support help individuals face challenges and achieve success.

21. The story 'The Serang of Ranaganji' reflects the virtue of kindness and compassion. Prepare a **review** of the story.

The Serang of Ranaganji' is a touching story that highlights kindness, courage and compassion. The story takes place aboard a ship carrying hundreds of Indian soldiers. When a contagious disease spreads among the soldiers, many people are afraid to help them. However, Hassan, the serang of the ship, comes forward to care for the sick soldiers without worrying about his own safety. His selfless service and humanity inspire others. The story shows that true greatness lies in helping others during difficult times. It teaches us that kindness and compassion are more valuable than fear and selfishness. Hassan stands as an example of courage and humanity.

22. You get an opportunity to interview Jane Wilde, wife of Stephen Hawking. Write **three questions** that you wish to ask her and the possible **responses**.

Q1. How did you support Stephen during his difficult times?
Jane: I supported him with love, care and encouragement throughout his life.
Q2. What inspired you to stay with him despite his illness?
Jane: My love for him and my belief in his abilities gave me strength.
Q3. What message would you like to give to people?
Jane: We should never lose hope and should face life's challenges with courage.

23. You are the reporter of a news channel. During a voyage through the Atlantic, you cross the area where the wrecking of The Titanic occurred. You go online when your cruise ship reaches the spot. Draft the **commentary** for your video.

Good morning! We are now at the site where the Titanic sank in 1912. The Titanic was one of the largest and most luxurious ships of its time. It struck an iceberg during its maiden voyage across the Atlantic Ocean and sank into the icy waters. More than 1,500 people lost their lives in this tragic disaster. The wreckage lies deep beneath the ocean, reminding us of the tragedy. This historic site continues to attract the attention of researchers and explorers around the world.

24. Maggie in 'The Price of Flowers' is a symbol of courage and commitment How far is this true ? Analyse her character and prepare a **character sketch** of Maggie.

Maggie, the central character in the story The Price of Flowers, is a young English girl who represents courage, love and commitment. She lives with her mother, Mrs. Clifford, and is deeply attached to her brother, Frank, who serves in India. Despite her poverty, she is determined to visit her brother's grave. She saves money by selling flowers and shows remarkable dedication to her family. Her visit to the grave reveals her deep love and emotional strength. Maggie's character teaches us that true love and commitment are more valuable than wealth.

25. After his visit to Nikolai's estate Ivan decides to buy a farmhouse somewhere near his brother's property. He writes a letter to Nikolai, expressing his wish. Draft the likely letter.

Dear Nikolai,
I hope you are doing well. I am writing to inform you that I wish to buy a farmhouse near your property. I was impressed by the beauty and peaceful atmosphere of the countryside.
I would like to settle in that area and enjoy the calm surroundings. Since you are familiar with the place, I hope you can help me find a suitable farmhouse at a reasonable price.
Please let me know if you come across any suitable property. I look forward to hearing from you soon.
Yours lovingly, Ivan

Questions 26 – 28 : Answer any two of the following. Each question carries 8 scores. **(2 × 8 = 16)**

26. You get an opportunity to address a group of NSS volunteers on Gandhi Jayanthi. Draft the speech referring to the need to sensitise our youth on the need to develop Gandhian values to maintain honesty and righteousness in our life.

Respected teachers and my dear friends,
Good morning to everyone.
Today, we have gathered here to celebrate Gandhi Jayanti, the birth anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi. He was a great leader who taught the world the values of truth, non-violence and simplicity.
Gandhiji believed that honesty and righteousness are essential for a good life. He showed us that even the greatest problems can be solved through peaceful means. As young people, we should follow his teachings in our daily lives.
We must speak the truth, respect others, avoid violence and help those in need. We should also fight against corruption and injustice. These values will help us build a peaceful and fair society.
Let us promise to follow Gandhian principles and become responsible citizens of our nation.
Thank you.

27. You are a travel and food vlogger. Prepare a **travel essay** on your favourite destination, highlighting the major tourist attractions, the local cuisine (food) and all other features of the place that make it special.

Munnar is my favourite tourist destination in Kerala. Located in the Western Ghats, it is famous for its beautiful hills, green tea plantations and cool climate. The mist-covered mountains and flowing waterfalls make it a wonderful place to visit.

Some of the major attractions are Eravikulam National Park, Mattupetty Dam and Echo Point. Visitors can enjoy trekking, boating and sightseeing. The vast tea gardens provide a peaceful atmosphere and beautiful views.

Munnar is also known for its delicious local food. Kerala dishes such as appam, puttu and Kerala-style meals are popular among visitors. The local tea is another special attraction.

The natural beauty, pleasant weather and peaceful surroundings make Munnar a perfect holiday destination. A visit to Munnar is a memorable experience for every traveller.

28. Read the given poem and write an **appreciation**, highlighting the theme, imagery, poetic devices and style.

On Health

Jan Kochanowski

My good and noble health,
Thou matter'st more then wealth.
None know'th thy worth until
Thou fad'st, and we fall ill.

And every man can see,
In stark reality,
And every man will say:
" 'Tis health I need today".

No better thing we know,
No dearer gem we owe,
For all that we possess:
Pearls, stones of great finesse,
High offices and power

The poem On Health by Jan Kochanowski highlights the importance of good health in human life. The poet considers health more valuable than wealth, precious stones, high positions and power.

The poem explains that people often fail to appreciate their health until they lose it. Once illness affects them, they realise that health is the greatest treasure. The poet uses imagery such as pearls and precious stones to compare material wealth with health. The repetition of ideas about health and wealth emphasises the poem's central message.

The language is simple and meaningful, and the poem follows a reflective style. The poet reminds us that no amount of money or power can replace good health. The poem teaches us to value our health and take care of ourselves.